MidiOrganize

User Guide · Version 1.6 · Free MIDI loop browser and player for Windows

MidiOrganize is a free, offline program that gets you from *"I need a drum groove"* to *"it's on my DAW track"* as quickly as possible. Point it at your folders of MIDI drum loops (Groove Monkee, EZdrummer MIDI exports, loops you have collected over the years), find a groove, audition it, and drag it into your DAW. No VST, no internet connection, and no load on your DAW.

Step	What you do	Where
1	**Bookmark** your loop folders once.	Section 2
2	**Browse** by clicking through the folders in the six side-by-side panes.	Section 3
3	**Preview** a loop: double-click it, then adjust tempo, volume and channel while it plays.	Section 5
4	**Drag** the loop straight from MidiOrganize into your DAW.	Section 6
+	**Chain** up to six loops together to hear them as a song (intro, verse, chorus…).	Section 7

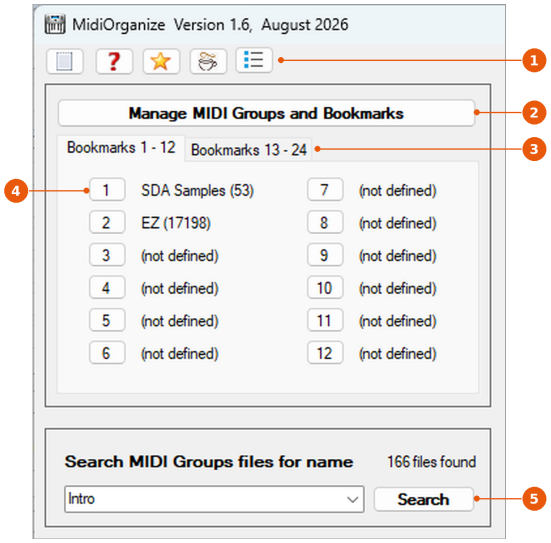
Good to know: what you hear while previewing comes from the Windows MIDI synthesizer (or whichever output device you choose). The file you drag into your DAW is always the original, unchanged .mid file - inside your DAW, your own drum instrument supplies the sound.

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1. The main window at a glance

The left-hand column holds everything you use to find and play a loop. The six wide panes to its right are where you browse (Section 3). A seventh area, the Groove Chain panel, stays hidden along the bottom until you open it (Section 7).



1	**Toolbar**	Left to right: Manage Bookmarks, **Help** (opens this guide), About, Buy Me a Coffee (optional support link), and the **Groove Chain** panel button.
2	**Manage MIDI Groups and Bookmarks**	Opens the window where you point MidiOrganize at your loop folders (Section 2).
3	**Bookmark tabs**	Bookmarks 1–12 and 13–24: room for 24 loop libraries.
4	**Bookmark buttons**	Click a number to open that library in the first pane. Beside each is its name and the number of files found - e.g. *SDA Samples (53)*. Unused slots say *(not defined)*.
5	**Search**	Type part of a loop or folder name; results appear in the first pane (Section 4).

Hover the mouse over almost any button or box for a short tooltip explaining it.

The preview panel below the search box is covered in detail in Section 5.

2. Setting up bookmarks to your loop folders

A **bookmark** is a named shortcut to the top folder of a loop library. You set each one up once; after that, a single click opens that library. You can keep up to 24 bookmarks, shown as numbered buttons on two tabs.

To add a bookmark

1. Click **Manage MIDI Groups and Bookmarks** (the wide button at the top of the left column, or the first toolbar button). The *MidiGroups and Bookmarks* window opens, with one row for each of the 24 bookmarks.
2. In an empty row, type a short **Name**. This is the label that appears next to the bookmark's button - for example *Groove Monkee* or *EZ Loops*.
3. Click the folder-browse button beside that row's **Directory** box and choose the **top-level folder** of the library. (You can also paste a folder path straight into the Directory box.)
4. Repeat for any other libraries you want to bookmark.
5. Click **Save**. The bookmark buttons refresh with your names and file counts. **Cancel** throws away anything you changed.

> **Tip:** choose the **top** of a library, not a deep subfolder. MidiOrganize looks inside every folder beneath a bookmark, so one bookmark such as *D:\Loops\EZ Loops* covers the whole collection, and you do the narrowing-down by clicking through the panes.

> **Caution:** a bookmark needs **both** a Name and a Directory. If either box is empty when you press Save, that row is cleared.

Changing or removing a bookmark

Open the same window and edit the Name or Directory of any row, or press that row's **Delete** button to clear it. Your changes only take effect when you press **Save**.

Other buttons in that window

Button	What it does
Save / Cancel	Keep or discard your changes.
Clear Temporary Files	Empties MidiOrganize's scratch folder (the copies made for search results and channel-converted previews). Your own loop files are never touched.
^ (next to *Configuration file*)	Opens MidiOrganize's settings file in Notepad. For advanced use only - everything in it is also set through the screens above.

> **Try it: Bookmark 1 is ready-made.** On first start it points to *SDA Samples*, the free drum loops that install with MidiOrganize (53 loops in 13 styles). Click it to try everything in this guide right away, before you bookmark your own libraries.

3. Navigating your loops in the six panes

Click a bookmark button and that library's top-level folders appear in the **first pane**. From there you simply keep clicking: each time you click a folder, its contents open in the next pane to the right. Because all six panes stay on screen, you can see the path you took and step back to any earlier level with one click.

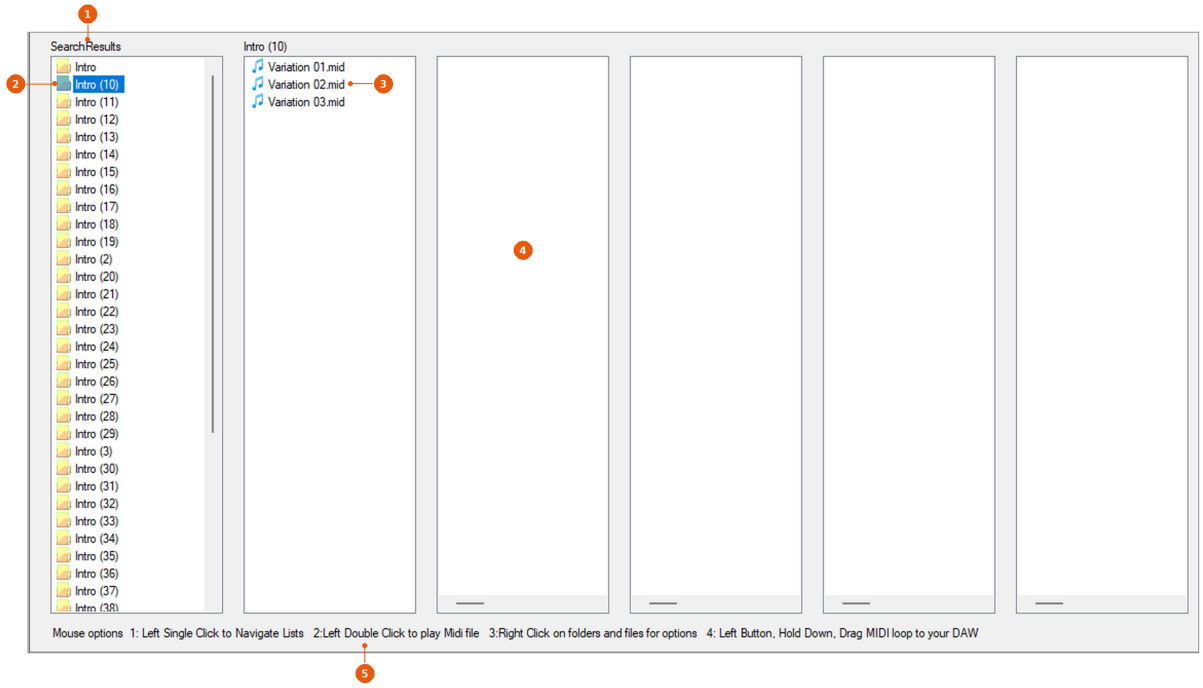


Figure: the panes after clicking a folder named *Intro (10)*. (These folders happen to be search results; ordinary browsing looks the same.)

1	**Pane heading**	The name of the folder whose contents are listed below it.
2	**Folders**	Yellow folder icon. **Click once** to open it in the next pane; any panes further right clear to make room.
3	**Loops**	Blue music-note icon = a MIDI file. Click once to select it (its full location appears on the path line), **double-click** to play it, or **press and drag** it into your DAW.
4	**Empty panes**	Fill from left to right as you go deeper - up to six levels are visible at once.
5	**Reminder bar**	The four mouse actions, summarized under the panes at all times.

Mouse actions

Action	On a folder	On a loop (.mid file)
Single click	Opens the folder in the next pane.	Selects it and shows its full path on the path line. It does *not* play.
Double-click	–	Plays the loop in the preview panel.
Right-click	Menu: copy path, open location.	Menu: play, play on channel 10, copy path, open location (below).
Press and drag	Moves or copies the folder (see “Moving files” below).	Carries the loop out to your DAW, Windows Explorer or the Groove Chain boxes.

The right-click menu

On a loop	What it does
Play ‘name’ in MS GS Wavetable Synth	Plays the loop on the output device chosen in the preview panel.
Play ‘name’ in MS GS WS on Channel 10	Ticks **Change Channel** for you and plays the loop on the channel number shown in the preview panel (10 by default) - handy for loops written on the wrong channel.
Copy ‘name’ Path to Clipboard	Copies the file’s full path so you can paste it elsewhere.
Open ‘name’ File Location	Opens Windows Explorer with this file selected.

Right-clicking a **folder** offers just the last two: *Copy Path to Clipboard* and *Open File Location*.

The path line

Above the panes, two lines show where you are. The top line is the bookmark’s root folder - click it to start over. Beneath it is the trail of folders you have drilled into; click any folder name in the trail to back up to that level. After the item count there is a small blue dot (●). **Click the blue dot to open that folder in Windows Explorer** (hover over it and the tip reads “Open file location”). The dot appears once you have opened at least one folder, and when you click a loop it opens the folder that holds that loop.

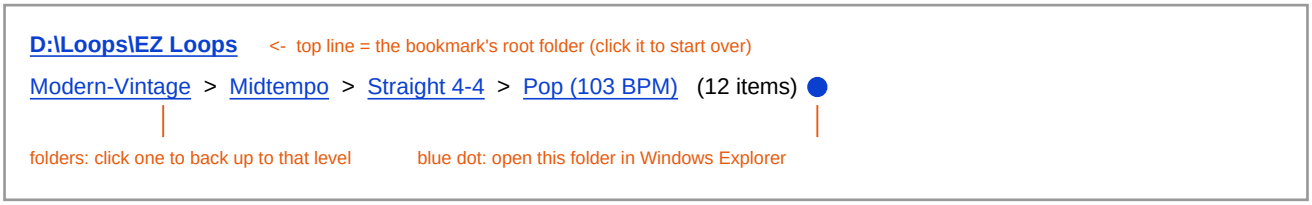


Illustration of the path line.

Moving and copying files between panes

You can reorganize your library without leaving MidiOrganize by dragging a file or folder from one pane onto another. Dragging **between MidiOrganize panes moves** the item (like cut and paste); dragging **in from Windows Explorer or the Desktop copies** it. If an item with the same name is already at the destination it is skipped, never overwritten, and you are shown a summary of what was skipped. Dropping an item into the folder it is already in does nothing.

> **Caution:** moving between panes changes the **real files on your disk**, not a copy. Drag carefully inside your own libraries; use Explorer if you want to keep the original in place.

4. Searching your whole library

The **Search** box looks through **all** of your bookmarks at once, not just the folder you happen to have open. Start typing part of a file or folder name (for example *intro*, *fill*, *shuffle* or *ride*) and the search runs by itself a moment after you stop typing; you can also press the **Search** button, or pick a word from the dropdown list. The label beside the box shows how many files were found.

Matching folders and loops are gathered into the **first pane** as a single flat list, so a folder called *Intro* is right there at the top level instead of being buried several folders deep. Click through the results exactly as you would any other folders. Click a loop in the results and the path line shows **where that loop really lives** in your library; the blue dot opens that real location in Explorer.

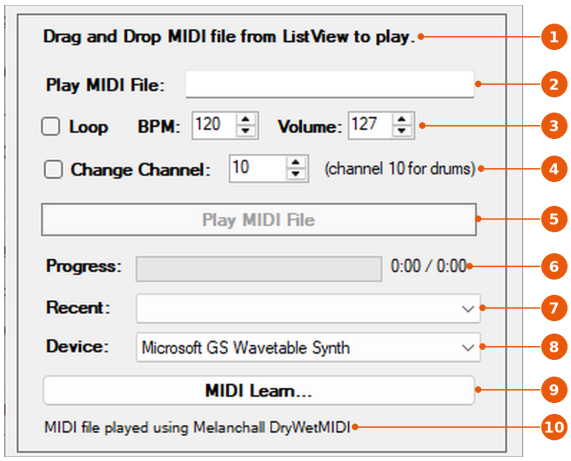
Tip: search results are temporary *copies* kept in MidiOrganize's scratch folder and replaced by each new search. Your original files are never changed by a search. Searching for words such as *Intro*, *Fill* and *Outro* is a quick way to collect the section loops you need for a Groove Chain (Section 7).

5. Previewing loops - the preview panel in detail

The preview panel (lower left) is MidiOrganize's built-in player. It plays any **.mid** file through your computer's MIDI synthesizer using the open-source *DryWetMIDI* library, and lets you change tempo, volume and channel while the loop is playing - without touching the original file.

Ways to start a loop playing

Method	How
Double-click	Double-click a loop in any pane.
Right-click	Right-click a loop and choose *Play* (or *Play on Channel 10*).
Drag and drop	Drop a .mid file anywhere on the preview panel - from a pane or from Windows Explorer.
Recent list	Pick a file you have played before from the **Recent** dropdown.
Play button	Press **Play MIDI File** to play (or replay) whatever is loaded.



1. **Drop area**
2. **File name box**
3. **Loop · BPM · Volume**
4. **Change Channel**
5. **Play / Stop button**
6. **Progress**
7. **Recent**
8. **Device**
9. **MIDI Learn**
10. **Credit line**

The preview panel. Numbers match the table below.

	Control	What it does
1	**Drop area**	The heading reads *Drag and Drop MIDI file from ListView to play.* A .mid file dropped anywhere on this panel starts playing at once. If several files are dropped together, the first .mid among them plays.
2	**Play MIDI File (name box)**	Shows the name of the loop that is loaded. When a Groove Chain is loaded it reads *(groove chain- see panel below)* instead.

	Control	What it does
3a	**Loop**	Tick it and the loop repeats until you press Stop. The repeat is timed from the true end of the last bar, so a loop whose final note ends early still comes around *in time*. With a Groove Chain, it repeats the whole chain (Section 7).
3b	**BPM**	Shows the loop's own tempo as soon as it loads. Type a new value or use the arrows (range 20–400); the change takes effect **immediately**, even mid-loop. This is how you audition a groove at *your song's* tempo. The file itself is never altered.
3c	**Volume**	Scales how hard every note is played, from 0 to 127, live. It starts at 127 (the loop exactly as written) each time a new loop loads. It affects the preview only - not your DAW and not the file.
4	**Change Channel**	Drum loops are meant for MIDI **channel 10**. A loop written on another channel would sound like a piano or other melodic instrument on the Windows synth. Tick the box to play the loop on the channel shown in the number box (10 by default; you can choose 1–16). MidiOrganize makes a temporary converted copy for playback; **the original is never modified**, and a loop you drag into your DAW is always the original.
5	**Play / Stop button**	Reads **Play MIDI File** when idle and **Stop Playing MIDI File** while playing. It is greyed out until a loop (or a Groove Chain) is loaded.
6	**Progress**	A bar and a time readout (*elapsed / length*) for the loop that is playing.
7	**Recent**	The last 15 single loops you played, newest first, remembered between sessions. Pick one to play it again. (Individual Groove Chain steps are not added.)
8	**Device**	Chooses the MIDI output used for previews. The default is *Microsoft GS Wavetable Synth*, built into Windows. If you have a hardware sound module or a virtual MIDI synth, select it here; your choice is remembered. Changing device while playing stops the loop - press Play to restart.
9	**MIDI Learn...**	Lets a MIDI foot pedal or controller operate Play/Stop, tempo and volume hands-free (Section 8).
10	**Credit line**	The playback engine is the DryWetMIDI library by Melanchall.

Tip: a quick audition workflow: set **BPM** to your project's tempo, tick **Loop**, and try several loops back to back by double-clicking them - then drag the one you like into your DAW. Only .mid files can be played; other file types may appear in the panes but are not supported for playback.

6. Dragging loops into your DAW

When you have found the right loop, take it straight into your project:

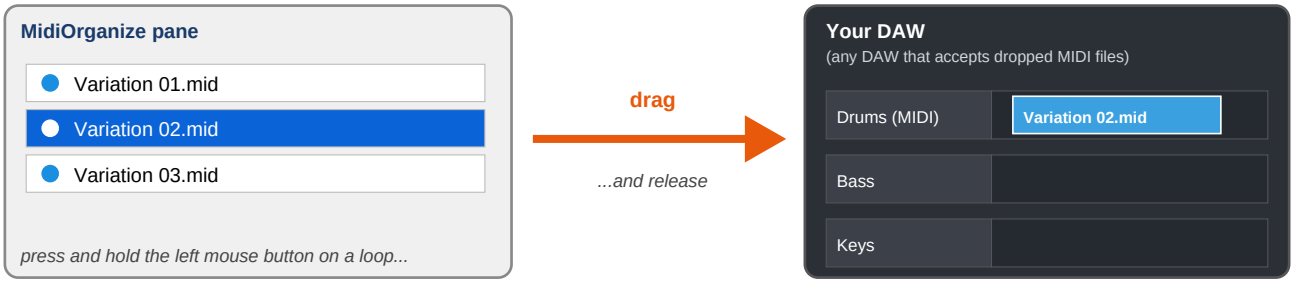


Illustration: dragging a loop from a MidiOrganize pane onto a MIDI track in the DAW.

1. Arrange the windows so that part of your DAW's track area is visible next to (or behind) MidiOrganize.
2. **Press and hold the left mouse button** on a loop in any pane.
3. Keep holding and **drag** the loop out of MidiOrganize and onto a MIDI or drum track in your DAW (or onto empty space, if your DAW creates a new track for dropped MIDI).
4. **Release** the mouse button. The loop is placed on the timeline.

> **Tip:** what you drag is a **copy of the original .mid file**. MidiOrganize never moves or deletes anything when you drag to a DAW, and the preview settings (BPM, Volume, Change Channel) do *not* change it - your DAW applies its own project tempo and its own drum instrument. Each DAW handles dropped MIDI a little differently (new track, selected track, or the cursor position), so check where yours puts it.

You can use the same press-and-drag move to drop a loop onto a Groove Chain box (next section) or into a Windows Explorer folder to make a copy.

7. Groove Chains - building a song from loops

A **Groove Chain** lets you line up to six loops and play them back to back, so you can hear an intro, verse, chorus and outro together before you commit anything to your DAW. It lives in its own panel along the bottom of the window.

Opening the panel

Click the **list-icon button at the right-hand end of the toolbar** (its tooltip reads *Show the Groove Chain panel*). The window grows slightly taller and the Groove Chain panel appears. Click the same button again (*Hide the Groove Chain panel*) to put it away; the window returns to its compact size.

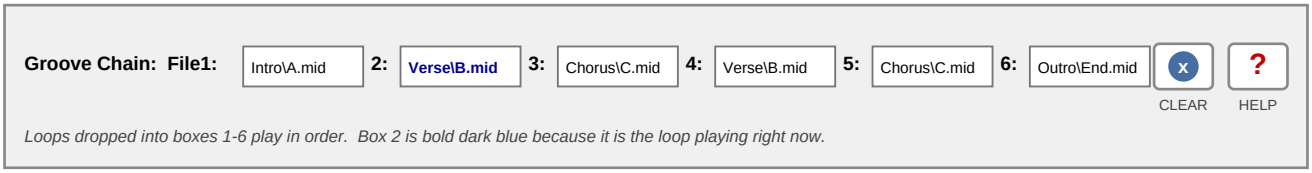


Illustration of the Groove Chain panel (example loop names).

Building and playing a chain

1. **Drag a loop** from any pane (or from Windows Explorer) onto **File1**. Only .mid files are accepted. The box shows the loop's folder and file name, e.g. *Intro\Main A.mid*, so you can tell at a glance where each piece came from.
2. Drag more loops onto boxes **2–6**, in the order you want to hear them. You do not have to fill all six - empty boxes are skipped. The same loop may be used in more than one box (verse twice, for instance).
3. Press the normal **Play MIDI File** button. If any chain box is filled, the chain plays - starting at File1 and moving through each filled box in turn. The box that is playing right now turns **bold dark blue**.
4. Press **Stop Playing MIDI File** at any time to stop. Press **CLEAR** (the blue × button) to empty all six boxes, and **HELP** (the red ? button) for an on-screen reminder.

How the other controls behave during a chain

Control	With a Groove Chain
Loop	Repeats the **whole chain** from File1 after the last filled box finishes (rather than repeating one loop).
BPM	The chain plays at the tempo of the **first** loop and holds it all the way through, so every part of your "song" stays at one consistent tempo even if the loops were written at different speeds. You can still change BPM while it plays, and the new tempo applies to the rest of the chain.
Volume	Starts at 127 when the chain starts and then carries through every step - it is not reset between loops.
Change Channel	If ticked, every loop in the chain is played on the chosen channel, just as for a single loop.
Progress	Shows the position within the loop that is currently playing.
Recent	Chain steps are not added to the Recent list.
Output device	The MIDI output stays open for the whole chain, which keeps the changeover from one loop to the next as tight as possible.

An example arrangement

File1	File2	File3	File4	File5	File6
Intro	Verse	Chorus	Verse	Chorus	Outro

Tip: use the Search box (Section 4) to pull up all of your *Intro*, *Fill* or *Outro* loops in one place, then drag the ones you like straight from the results into the chain boxes.

Note: a Groove Chain is for **auditioning an arrangement inside MidiOrganize**; it does not save a combined file. To use the arrangement in your DAW, drag each loop into your DAW in the same order (Section 6).

8. MIDI Learn - hands-free control from a foot pedal

If you have a MIDI foot pedal board or other controller, you can start and stop loops and change tempo and volume without taking your hands off your instrument. Press **MIDI Learn...** in the preview panel to open the mapping window. It can learn five commands: **Play/Stop**, **Tempo Up**, **Tempo Down**, **Volume Up** and **Volume Down**.

1. Choose your MIDI interface from the dropdown at the top of the window.
2. Click **Learn** next to the command you want to set.
3. Press the button, key or pedal on your controller. MidiOrganize shows the message it received and assigns it automatically - no extra confirmation. It understands note, control-change and program-change messages.
4. Repeat for the other commands, then click **OK**.

Each Tempo press changes the BPM by 1, and each Volume press changes the volume by 8. Your assignments are saved and reloaded every time MidiOrganize starts, as long as the same MIDI interface is connected.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Play MIDI File is greyed out	Nothing is loaded yet. Double-click a loop, drop a .mid file on the preview panel, or fill at least one Groove Chain box.
I hear nothing	Check the **Device** dropdown. Windows includes *Microsoft GS Wavetable Synth*; if you chose another device, make sure it is connected and switched on. Also check that **Volume** is not set very low.
The loop sounds like a piano, not drums	It was written on a different MIDI channel. Tick **Change Channel** (channel 10), or right-click it and choose *Play ... on Channel 10*.
A bookmark shows no loops, or the wrong number	The folder may have been moved or renamed. Open *Manage MIDI Groups and Bookmarks* and point that bookmark at its new location, then Save.
Single-clicking a loop does not play it	That is intentional - a single click only selects it and shows its path. **Double-click** to play.
The search finds nothing	Searching matches part of a file or folder *name* and looks in your bookmarked folders only. Try a shorter word, and check that a bookmark is defined.
MIDI Learn does not respond	Select the correct MIDI interface in the MIDI Learn window, and make sure no other program (your DAW, another MIDI utility) has that device open exclusively.
A file will not play or shows an error	Some loops from older or less common sources are non-standard or damaged. Try another file from the same pack to see whether the problem is just that one file.
A dragged loop does nothing in my DAW	Drop it onto a MIDI or instrument track, or onto empty space in the track area; some DAWs ignore drops onto audio tracks. Make sure you released the mouse button over the DAW window.

10. Help, About and support

The **Help** button on the toolbar (the red **?**) opens this guide. **About** (the star) shows the installed version and release date. MidiOrganize is free for personal and professional use; if you find it useful, the optional **Buy Me a Coffee** button supports its development - it is never required.

Sierra Digital Audio
Website: sierradigitalaudio.com · Email: SierraDigitalAudio@gmail.com
Playback engine: DryWetMIDI by Melanchall (open source).